

Linux Commands and Shell Scripting - Final Project



Estimated time needed: **90** minutes

Welcome to the hands-on lab for the final project!

In this scenario, you are a lead Linux developer at the top-tech company ABC International Inc. As one of ABC Inc.'s most trusted Linux developers, you have been tasked with creating a script called `backup.sh` which runs every day and automatically backs up any encrypted password files that have been updated in the past 24 hours.

Please complete the following tasks, and be sure to follow the directions as you go. Don't forget to save your work.

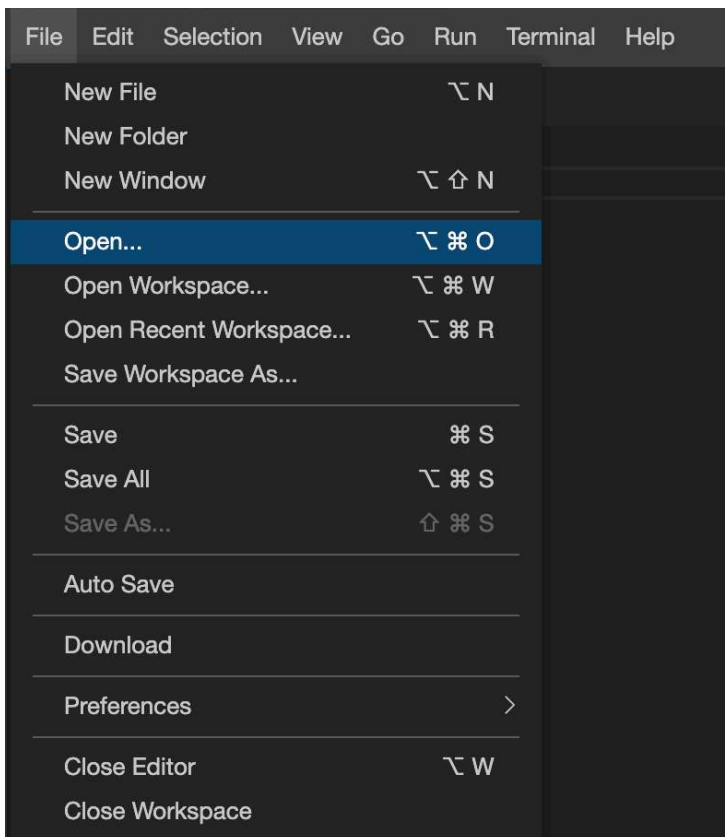
Getting started

Task 0

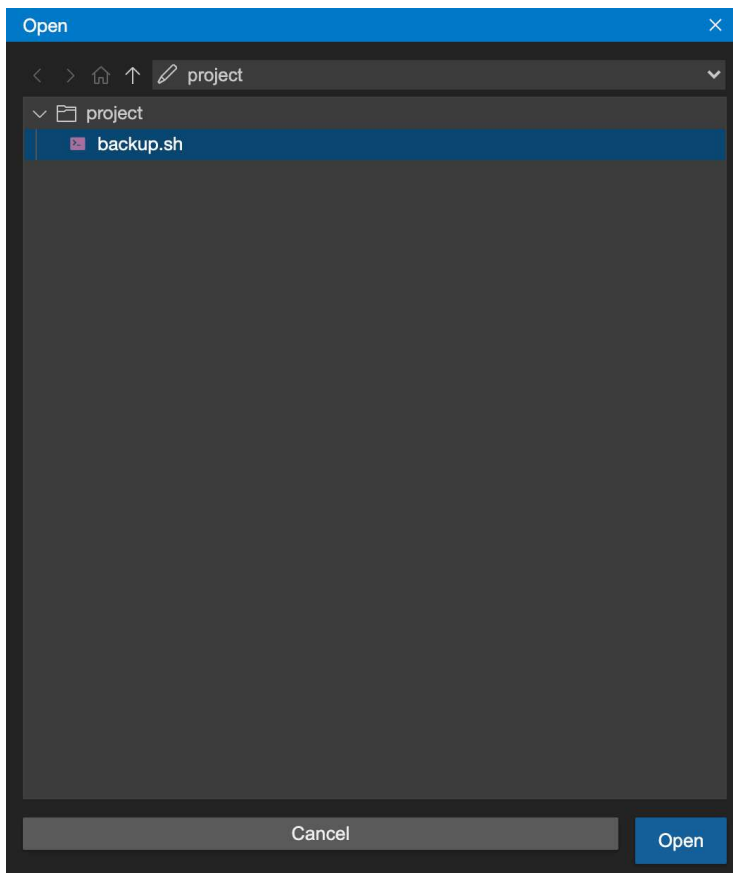
1. Open a new terminal by clicking on the menu bar and selecting **Terminal->New Terminal**:
2. Download the template file `backup.sh` by running the command below:

```
wget https://cf-courses-data.s3.us.cloud-object-storage.appdomain.cloud/pWN3k02yWEuKMvYJdcLPQg/backup.sh
```

3. Open the file in the IDE by clicking **File->Open** as seen below:



then click on the file, which should have been downloaded to your project directory:



About the template script backup.sh

1. You will notice the template script contains comments (lines starting with the # symbol). Do **not** delete these.

The ones that look like # [TASK {number}] will be used by your grader:

```

backup.sh x temp.sh
# backup.sh
1 # This checks if the number of arguments is correct
2 # If the number of arguments is incorrect ( $# != 2 ) print error message and exit
3 if [[ $# != 2 ]]
4 then
5     echo "backup.sh target_directory_name destination_directory_name"
6     exit
7 fi
8
9 # This checks if argument 1 and argument 2 are valid directory paths
10 if [[ ! -d $1 ]] || [[ ! -d $2 ]]
11 then
12     echo "Invalid directory path provided"
13     exit
14 fi
15
16 # [TASK 1]
17 targetDirectory=
18 destinationDirectory=
19
20 # [TASK 2]
21 echo ""
22 echo ""
23
24 # [TASK 3]
25 currentTS=""
26
27 # [TASK 4]
28 backupFileName=""
  
```

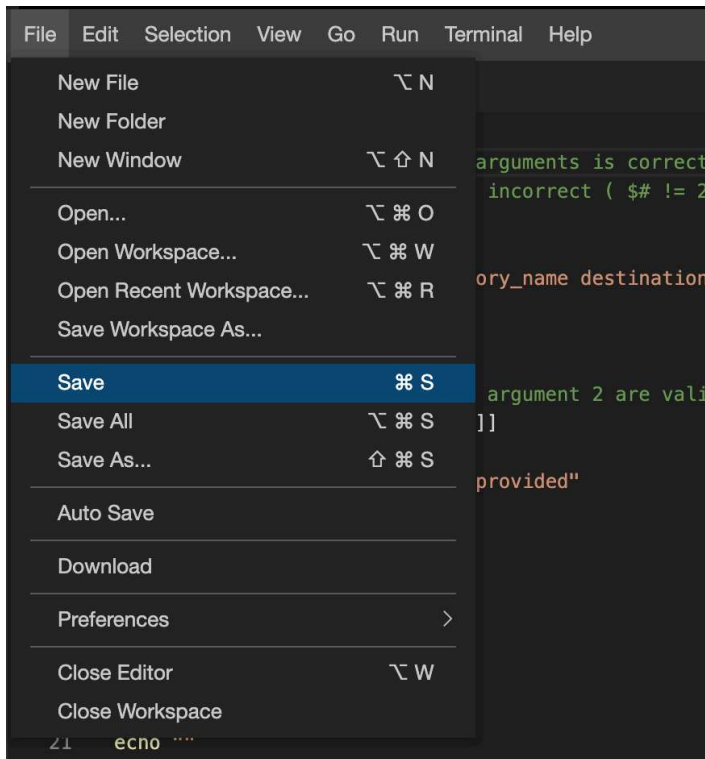
2. Also, please do **not** modify any existing code above # [TASK 1] in the script.

Saving your progress

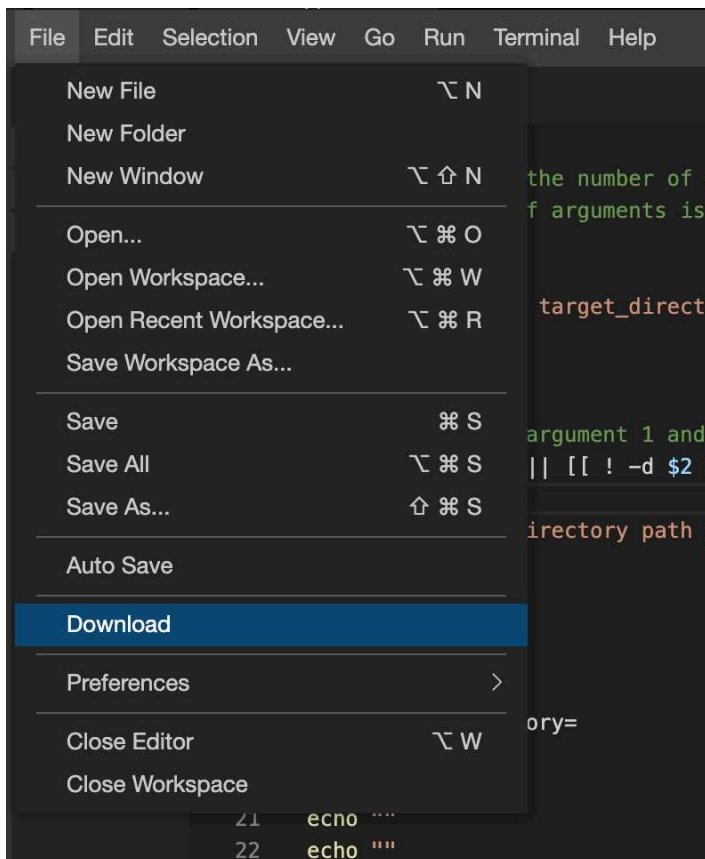
Your work **will not** be saved if you exit your session.

In order to save your progress:

1. Save the current working file (backup.sh) with CTRL+s [Windows/Linux], CMD+s [MAC], or navigate to **File->Save** as seen below:



2. Download the file to your local computer by navigating to **File->Download** as seen below:



3. Unfortunately, our editor does **not** currently support file uploading, so you will need to copy and paste your work as follows:

- To "upload" your in-progress backup.sh file and continue working on it:
 1. Open a terminal and type `touch backup.sh`
 2. Open the empty backup.sh file in the editor
 3. Copy-paste the contents of your locally-saved backup.sh file into the empty backup.sh file in the editor

Task 1

Navigate to # [TASK 1] in the code.

Set two variables equal to the values of the first and second command line arguments, as follows:

1. Set `targetDirectory` to the first command line argument
2. Set `destinationDirectory` to the second command line argument

This task is meant to help with code readability.

▼ Click here for Hint

The command line arguments interpreted by the script can be accessed via `$1` (first argument) and `$2` (second argument).

Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `01-Set_Variables.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 2

1. Display the values of the two command line arguments in the terminal.

► Click here for Hint

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `02-Display_Values.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 3

1. Define a variable called `currentTS` as the current timestamp, expressed in seconds.

► Click here for Hint

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `03-CurrentTS.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 4

1. Define a variable called `backupFileName` to store the name of the archived and compressed backup file that the script will create.

The variable `backupFileName` should have the value `"backup-[$currentTS].tar.gz"`

- For example, if `currentTS` has the value `1634571345`, then `backupFileName` should have the value `backup-1634571345.tar.gz`.

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `04-Set_Value.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 5

1. Define a variable called `origAbsPath` with the absolute path of the current directory as the variable's value.

► Click here for Hint

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `05-Define_Variable.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 6

1. Define a variable called `destAbsPath` whose value equals the absolute path of the destination directory.

► Click here for Hint

Note: Please Note that you can also use the `cd "destinationDirectory" || exit` which ensures that if the specified directory is incorrect or inaccessible, the script will terminate immediately at this step. This acts as an implicit validation check to confirm that the correct directory is provided before proceeding with further operations. Follow the same for Task 7 .

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `06-Define_Variable.jpg` or `.png`.

Checkpoint



Friendly reminder to save your work to your local computer!

Task 7

1. Change directories from the current working directory to the target directory `targetDirectory`.

► [Click here for Hint](#)

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `07-Change_Directory.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 8

You need to find files that have been updated within the past 24 hours. This means you need to find all files whose last-modified date was 24 hours ago or less.

To do make this easier:

1. Define a numerical variable called `yesterdayTS` as the timestamp (in seconds) 24 hours prior to the current timestamp, `currentTS`.

► [Click here for Hint](#)

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `08-YesterdayTS.jpg` or `.png`.

Note on arrays

In the script, you will notice the line:

```
declare -a toBackup
```

This line declares a variable called `toBackup`, which is an **array**. An array contains a list of values, and you can append items to arrays using the following syntax:

```
myArray+=($myVariable)
```

When you print or echo an array, you will see its string representation, which is simply all of its values separated by spaces:

```
$ declare -a myArray
$ myArray+=("Linux")
$ myArray+=("is")
$ myArray+=("cool!")
$ echo ${myArray[@]}
Linux is cool!
```

This will be useful later in the script where you will pass the array `$toBackup`, consisting of the names of all files that need to be backed up, to the `tar` command. This will archive all files at once!

Task 9

1. In the for loop, use the wildcard to iterate over all files and directories in the current folder.

► [Click here for Hint](#)

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `09-List_AllFilesandDirectoryess.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 10

1. Inside the for loop, you want to check whether the `$file` was modified within the last 24 hours.

To get the last-modified date of a file in seconds, use `date -r $file +%s` then compare the value to `yesterdayTS`.

if `[[ $file_last_modified_date -gt $yesterdayTS ]]` then the file was updated within the last 24 hours!

2. Since much of this wasn't covered in the course, for this task you may copy the code below and paste it into the double square brackets `[[ ]]`:

```
`date -r $file +%s` -gt $yesterdayTS
```

3. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `10-IF_Statement.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 11

1. In the if-then statement, add the `$file` that was updated in the past 24-hours to the `toBackup` array.
2. Since much of this wasn't covered in the course, you may copy the code below and place after the then statement for this task:

```
toBackup+=($file)
```

3. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `11-Add_File.jpg` or `.png`.

Checkpoint



Friendly reminder to save your work to your local computer!

Task 12

1. After the `for` loop, **compress** and **archive** the files, using the `$toBackup` array of filenames, to a file with the name `backupFileName`.

► [Click here for Hint](#)

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `12-Create_Backup.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 13

Now the file `$backupFileName` is created in the current working directory.

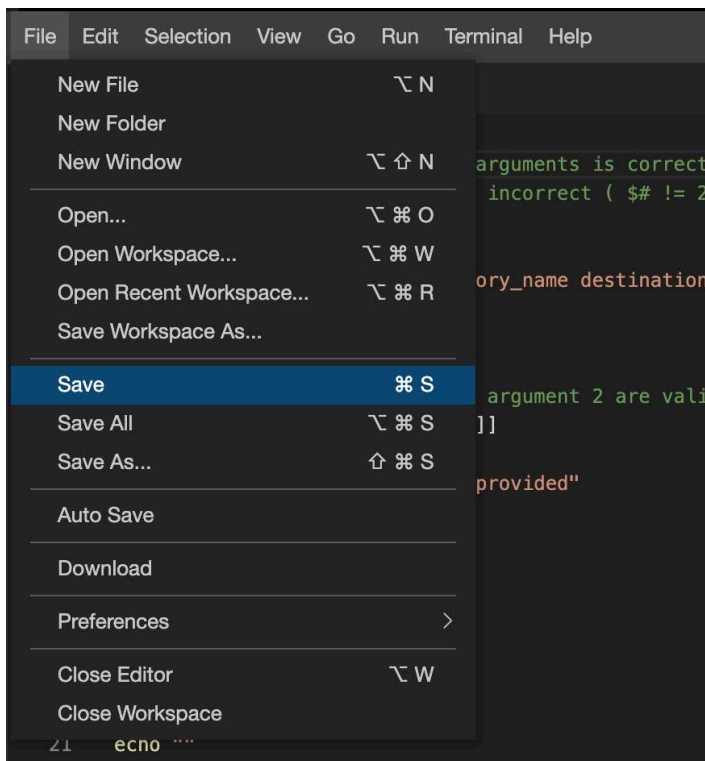
► [Click here for Hint](#)

2. Take a screenshot of the code above and save it as `13-Move_Backup.jpg` or `.png`.

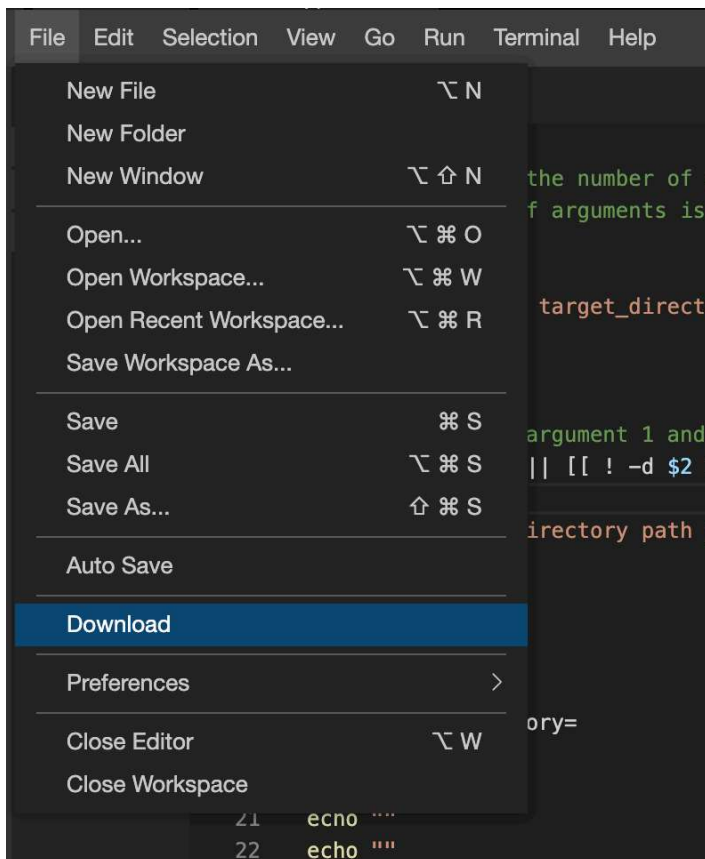
Congratulations! You have now done the coding portion of the lab!

Task 14

1. Save the current working file `backup.sh` with `CTRL+s` [Windows/Linux], `CMD+s` [MAC] or by navigating to **File->Save** as seen below:



2. Download the file to your local computer by navigating to **File->Download** as seen below:

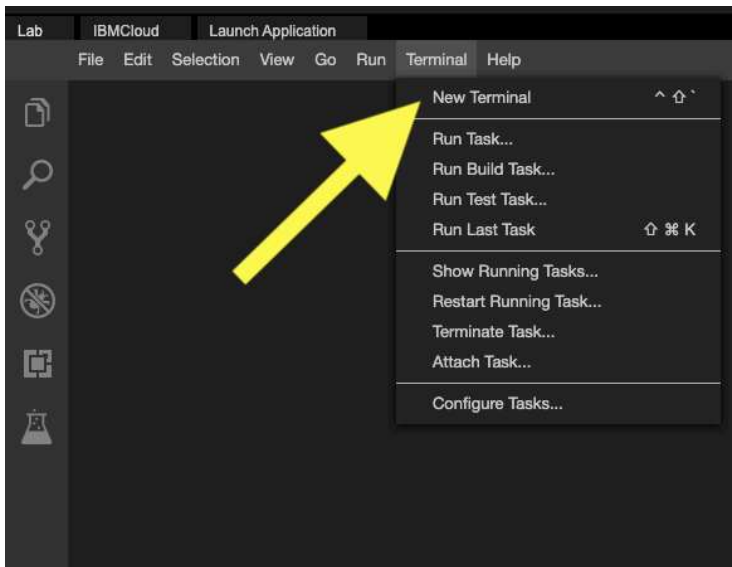


You may save the file as `backup.sh`

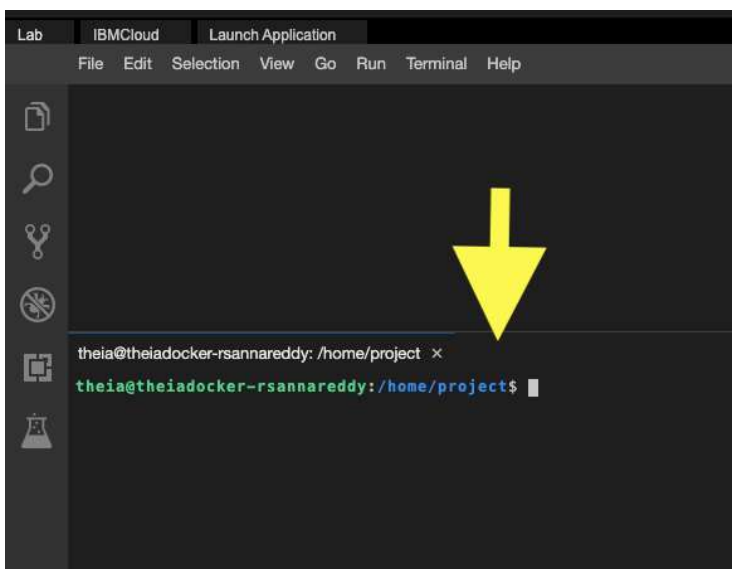
3. You will later submit this file will for peer-grading.

Task 15

1. Open a new terminal by clicking on the menu bar and selecting **Terminal->New Terminal**, as in the image below:



This will open a new terminal at the bottom of the screen as seen below:



2. Save the backup.sh file you're working on and make it executable.

► [Click here for Hint](#)

3. Verify the file is executable using the `ls` command with the `-l` option:

```
ls -l backup.sh
```

4. Take a screenshot of the output of the command above and save it as `15-executable.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 16

1. Download the following .zip file with the `wget` command:

```
wget https://cf-courses-data.s3.us.cloud-object-storage.appdomain.cloud/IBM-LX0117EN-SkillsNetwork/labs/Final%20Project/important-documents.zip
```

2. Unzip the archive file:

```
unzip -DDo important-documents.zip
```

Note: -DDo overwrites without restoring original modified date.

3. Update the file's last-modified date to **now**:

```
touch important-documents/*
```

4. Test your script using the following command:

```
./backup.sh important-documents .
```

This should have created a file called `backup-[CURRENT_TIMESTAMP].tar.gz` in your current directory.

5. Take a screenshot of the output of `ls -l` and save it as `16-backup-complete.jpg` or `.png`.

Task 17

1. **Copy** the `backup.sh` script into the `/usr/local/bin/` directory. (Do **not** use `mv`.)

Note: You may need to use `sudo cp` in order to create a file in `/usr/local/bin/`.

2. Test the cronjob to see if the backup script is getting triggered by scheduling it for every 1 minute.

► [Click here for Hint](#)

3. Please note that since the Theia Lab is a virtual environment, we need to explicitly start the cron service using the below command:

```
sudo service cron start
```

4. Once the cron service is started, check in the directory `/home/project` to see if the `.tar` files are being created.

5. If they are, then stop the cron service using the below command, otherwise it will continue to create `.tar` files every minute:

```
sudo service cron stop
```

6. Using crontab, schedule your `/usr/local/bin/backup.sh` script to backup the `important-documents` folder every 24 hours to the directory `/home/project`.
7. Take a screenshot of the output of `crontab -l` and save as `17-crontab.jpg` or `.png`.

Tip: When you are setting up cron jobs in a real-life scenario, ensure the cron service is running, or start the cron service if needed.

Congratulations!

You have completed the final lab for this course! Well done!

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